

My Yarn Stash

Photo of the yarn label, AI auto-fills everything, matches to Ravelry patterns from your stash. Plus shop commissions.

What it is

My Yarn Stash is an iOS + Android app for hobby knitters and crocheters. Photograph the yarn label, AI extracts material, yardage, needle recommendation, manufacturer and colour. The app then matches Ravelry patterns the user can actually knit with their current stash. Plus: project tracking, FO logbook (finished objects), pattern-match history, and group sharing for knit circles. Two revenue rails: 50% on Premium subs AND a share of Awin shop commissions when the referred user buys yarn in-app.

Who it is for

Hobby knitters, crocheters and fibre artists from beginners with a single shelf to power users with several hundred labels. Audience skews ~90% female, high purchasing power (yarn is consistently re-bought every 3-6 weeks), EU + US + UK + AU. Creator archetypes that convert well: independent pattern designers, KnittingTok and CrochetTok creators (very high engagement vertical), indie yarn dyers (already trusted by stash collectors), stash-tour reel makers, finished-project carousel creators, granny-square content, fibre-festival recap creators.

Key features

- Vision-AI label scan: material, yardage, needle, manufacturer, colourway and weight extracted from one label photo.
- Pattern matching: stash items matched against Ravelry patterns. "Patterns I can knit right now from my stash" is the unique pitch.
- Project tracking + FO logbook: in-progress projects with photo, finished objects archive, yardage actually used per project.
- Group sharing for knit circles: 1 small group on Free (5 members), unlimited groups on Premium.
- Awin in-app shop rail: deep-linked Knit Picks and Minerva purchases, no separate browser flow.
- Discover tab for pattern designers: designers list patterns directly, reach the stash audience.

Business model

- Two revenue streams: recurring Premium subscription + Awin shop commission share.
- Premium pricing: 4.99 USD / month or 29.99 USD / year (no annual discount, no free trial - live-trial-on-paywall).
- Free tier generous: 30 yarn items, 1 group up to 5 members, manual entry + photo scan, pattern-match search.
- Premium unlocks: unlimited stash, unlimited groups, AI pattern-match recommendations, advanced project tracking.
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates, no posting obligation.

Pricing

- Premium: 4.99 USD / month or 29.99 USD / year.
- Shop rail: Klar earns ~5-10% Awin commission per basket; affiliate share is a portion of that for 24 months from the referred user's first purchase.
- ASC live since May 2026; affiliate share is always 50% of the then-current Premium price.

Market gap - what was missing

Ravelry's mobile experience has been genuinely broken since the 2020 redesign disaster. Ravelry has 10M+ registered users, most of whom maintain stash and pattern queues, but the official mobile app is functionally abandoned - accessibility complaints from neurodivergent users led to the redesign rollback, the underlying tech is still 2015-era, and there is no AI-anything. Meanwhile every knitter has a phone, a physical stash growing in their living room, and the chronic problem of "I know I have yarn for this pattern, I just can't remember". That is the gap. My Yarn Stash fills it with better UX, AI auto-fill (label scan that nothing else offers), and pattern-match recommendations against the user's actual stash. The Awin shop rail is the second unlock - knitters re-buy yarn constantly, so a single converted user's lifetime affiliate value compounds on every restock.

Why now

Three shifts make My Yarn Stash possible in 2026. First, Vision LLM costs dropped enough that scanning every yarn label at 0.005-0.01 USD per call is economically viable inside a 5 USD/month price point. Second, Ravelry's API access has been stable enough since 2024 that pattern matching against a live stash is reliable. Third, Awin's iOS-deep-link infrastructure matured enough in 2024-2025 that in-app yarn purchases attribute cleanly through to the affiliate. The combination of free Ravelry data + cheap Vision AI + working Awin attribution closed a window that wouldn't have been buildable 3 years ago.

Affiliate compensation

- 50% of net Premium subscription revenue for 24 months from each attributed user's first paid month.
- 30-day refund holdback before payout becomes claimable (Apple / Google refund window).
- 50 EUR minimum payout, monthly, via Wise.
- Free Lifetime Premium for onboarded affiliates (no posting obligation).
- Per-handle dashboard with live click / install / sub / earning split, no agency layer.

How tracking works - DIY attribution stack

Most affiliate stacks ride on top of Branch.io, AppsFlyer or a similar paid attribution SDK. We built our own. Those tools charge per attributed install, they add a third party to the user's first-launch experience, and they make influencer payouts opaque. My Yarn Stash has a unique wrinkle - two revenue streams (Premium sub + Awin shop commission) need to attribute to the same handle across different RC and Awin event types. Here is what runs in each stage.

Why we built our own instead of Branch.io

Three reasons. (1) Cost: paid SDKs absorb 8-12% of the affiliate payout pool. (2) Privacy: extra SDKs add another vendor reading first-launch context. (3) Transparency: when a dashboard number looks wrong, we read our own code in 10 minutes. Every line of attribution is in our repo.

Android: Google Play install-referrer

Android gives us the cleanest path. The Google Play Store install carries the original referrer string through to first launch via the Play Install Referrer API. On first launch the app reads it, parses the handle, and writes an attribution row alongside the install event. Deterministic. No fingerprinting. No clipboard.

iOS warm (app already installed)

If the user already has My Yarn Stash installed, iOS routes the tap through a Universal Link directly into the app with the handle in the URL path. We register `yarnstash.app/ii/*` as a Universal Link, Apple's CDN serves the ``apple-app-site-association`` JSON, the OS routes the tap. Deep-link handler reads the URL, extracts the handle, writes the attribution row.

iOS cold (~99% of creator traffic)

The hard case - and ~99% of creator traffic - is iOS cold install. iOS gives the freshly installed app no context. Branch.io solves this with device-fingerprinting heuristics that became unreliable after iOS 14.5. We do it differently. When a user taps your link in Safari, our redirect chain hits `yarnstash.app/ii/[handle]`. That page writes a short-lived JSON token to the clipboard (handle, timestamp, app-key, HMAC-SHA256 signature) before redirecting to the App Store. After install, on first launch, the app reads the clipboard once, parses the JSON, verifies the signature, accepts the token if fresh and signed, and writes the attribution row.

Optional first-open confirmer

Optional fallback. On first open, after we've read whatever the clipboard provided, the app can show a single confirmation: "Invited by @[suggested-handle]? Yes / No". Pre-filled with the clipboard suggestion. My Yarn Stash runs the confirmer ON because knitters are a careful audience that doesn't mind the extra explicit step.

RevenueCat webhook -> payout queue

Premium purchases flow through RevenueCat. When ``INITIAL_PURCHASE``, ``RENEWAL``, ``PRODUCT_CHANGE``, or ``CANCELLATION`` fires, RC posts JSON to our Supabase Edge function ``affiliate-rc-webhook``. The function verifies the RC signature, idempotency-checks, looks up the user's attribution row, computes 50% of net after Apple/Google cut, credits ``affiliate_earnings``. Separately, Awin shop purchases flow through Awin's postback API: when a user buys yarn via Knit Picks or Minerva in-app, Awin sends a postback to our Edge function ``affiliate-awin-postback``. The function maps the Awin click-ID back to our user-attribution row, computes the affiliate share of the commission, credits the same ``affiliate_earnings`` table with a different source-type so the dashboard can show both rails separately.

Holdback -> batch -> Wise

Each credited earning (Premium sub or Awin commission) enters a 30-day refund holdback (Apple/Google refund window for subs; Awin's own clawback window for shop commissions, typically 30-60 days). After holdback expires the row flips to ``claimable``. A `pg_cron` job runs ``build_payout_batch()`` on the 5th of each month: groups all ``claimable`` rows per affiliate (both sub and Awin revenue combined), applies the 50 EUR minimum, creates a batch per qualifying affiliate, enqueues to ``wise_dispatch_queue``. `wise-dispatch` calls Wise's v3 transfer API with the affiliate's stored Wise recipient ID. Yarn buyers re-purchase every 3-6 weeks on average, so the Awin tail in particular compounds meaningfully over the 24-month attribution window.

What you see on your dashboard

Your dashboard at getklar.org/dashboard shows the dual-rail funnel transparently: clicks per day/week/month, install split (Android / iOS warm / iOS cold), active Premium subs in your bucket, Awin shop purchases by referred users (count + cumulative commission), claimable USD from both rails separately AND combined, refund-holdback pipeline, next payout date.

Why this works as an affiliate pitch

Ravelry's mobile app is genuinely dead since the 2020 redesign disaster - 10M+ users without a native solution. My Yarn Stash fills the gap with better UX and AI auto-fill that nothing else offers. The pattern-match feature solves a real "stash blindness" pain. Two revenue rails mean affiliates earn on subs AND on every yarn purchase their referred user makes - knitters re-buy yarn every 3-6 weeks, so the Awin tail compounds meaningfully over 12-24 months.

On posts with affiliate link: #ad / #sponsored / Paid Partnership (FTC, EU disclosure law).